LVNA
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VILLAGER

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NEXT LVNA MEETING

Otto Lee, Santa Clara County Supervisor, and Diego Martinez, Board Aide for Otto Lee, will be joining us, via Zoom, on **Wednesday, February 10th, at 7:00 PM**, to discuss the role of a SCC Supervisor and to answer any questions that Lakewood Village residents have.

Some examples include:

- What is a county Supervisor? What are the responsibilities and what types of questions/concerns should go to a Supervisor vs. another representative?
- What would your approach be to helping the homeless move into temporary/stable housing?
- What assistance could be provided to help people on the edge of becoming homeless?
- What resources are available, or are in progress, to help those with mental illnesses?
- What are the zoning plans in regards to tall buildings in Santa Clara County?
- What is your approach to crime prevention and criminal justice?
- What steps is Santa Clara County taking in preparing for and mitigating effects of climate change?

Zoom meeting credentials will be available 1 hour before the start of the meeting at lvnasv.org/meeting

LVNA Website

LVNASV.org

Nextdoor LVNA Group

https://nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap/



DO YOU WANT TO FIND OUT WHAT YOUR HOME IS WORTH?

Ask Grace Keng Realtor
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FACTOID

After the recent downpours, followed by amazingly sunny days, this clover-imposter is starting to flourish. As you drive through the neighborhood, you'll likely notice the pretty yellow flowers… all over the place. In many cases, a quick glance in the backyard may be sufficient to spot the endless clumps of green heart-shaped foliage. Noticing a trend? Yeah, this stuff is everywhere!

Commonly called "Bermuda Buttercup" (Oxalis pes-caprae), this Oxalis-family weed seems to love the Bay Area. Once it takes hold, it's a pain to get rid of. Native to South Africa, this invasive, noxious weed was originally brought to California for its ornamental beauty – Whoops! The climate and soil here make excellent growing conditions so eradicating it requires some serious persistence and tests of patience.



FACTOID

CONT.

OK, why is all of this relevant? Well, Lakewood Village is covered with it. The invasive nature of this plant will completely smother out any other plants that can't out-grow it. Unfortunately, that pretty much describes the majority of our native species and all of the other pretty flowers we'd want in the garden. So, in addition to our yards becoming a homogenized blend of yellow and green, the bulbs also find their ways into our streams, wetlands, and parks, wreaking havoc on the native wildlife. Right now is the optimal time to dig them up because they're just starting to flower, indicating that they've exhausted their energy reserves. From now on, their leaves will continue to soak up the rays and they'll send all of that energy straight towards the growth of new bulbils (next year's plants). Each plant is capable of growing up to 20 of these new bulbils, translating to 20 new plants next year. You can see how this gets out of hand rather quickly.

There's a smidge of good news when it comes to their reproduction. Although they have flowers, they do not reproduce via seed transmission here in the Bay. All new plants come from existing roots, bulbs, and bulbils (next-year's bulbs), i.e., completely underground. If it weren't for birds and squirrels, their ability to spread would be limited to just a few inches each year. As you've likely guessed, our neighborhood wildlife ensures they have a way to go for distance. Aside from the wildlife, people are the predominant means for their spread when they move dirt around their own yard, share with friends/family, or when we purchase new contaminated plants from a nursery.

What to do –

- If you have an area contaminate by Oxalis, do not spread the dirt anywhere else in the yard. Remember, the plant's natural ability to spread is only a couple inches each year so moving that dirt, if it contains bulbs/bulbils, increases the potential coverage.
- Hand-digging is the most effective, albeit labor- and time-intensive, method for organic eradication. Using a hand weeder or a shovel, dig below the bulb, lifting up the dirt while gently pulling on the plant. The goal is to get the plant AND the bulb. It may take some practice and, even then, there will likely be many failed attempts to get the bulb. But rest assured that each time you dig it up you're chopping off its source of energy. If you keep it up, eventually it won't be able to make it back to the surface again – You win!
- Another option for at least thinning out the growth the following year is solar sterilization. This can be accomplished during mid-summer by getting the soil wet and covering with clear UV-resistant plastic for about 6 weeks. Think of it as a steam-cleaning for your garden. Note that this method will only kill the bulbs in the top few inches of the soil, and that it'll kill most other things living in that layer as well {insects, fungi, helpful microbes, seeds}.
- It's a bit late this year, but covering the soil with a few layers of wet cardboard, followed by a few inches of compost or mulch, in late fall, can smother them as they start to sprout. They'll use all their energy attempting to reach sunlight that they won't be able to produce new bulbils that season.
- If all else fails, you may decide that chemicals are the only way to go. Remember to carefully read the instructions to limit the amount that goes into the soil and to avoid too much damage to surrounding plants. Also, keep in mind that these bulbs are resilient so it may still take years before you've completely eradicated it from your yard.

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PET OF THE MONTH



Meet Lara, our nine-year-old Grandcat. Lara lives the good life in Modesto and just moved into a new house in December. She loves her new backyard. She goes out to check that all is good and then goes right back inside to her favorite new spots. Lara joined the family nine years ago as a therapy cat for a, then eight-year-old, mildly autistic child. Both have thrived.....

Is your pet ready for the Villager spotlight? Submit your caption and photo to editor@lvnasv.org

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The views, opinions, and facts presented in the Villager are of their respective authors/creators and don't necessarily reflect the views or opinions of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association, its officers, residents or other sponsors.
If you'd like to submit an article, event, etc., for possible publication in a future edition of the Villager, please send an email to our editor(s) at editor@lvnasv.org



RECIPE CORNER

Pesto

4 CUPS basil leaves, packed
1 CUP parmesan, finely shredded
¾ CUP extra virgin olive oil
½ CUP pine nuts
1 TSP salt
3 garlic cloves

1. Add basil leaves, pine nuts, garlic, and salt to food processor. Process until finely minced.
2. With food processor running, stream in olive oil. Process until you've reached desired texture.
3. Add shredded parmesan and pulse with food processor to combine.
4. Taste and add additional salt, if needed. Enjoy!

Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.









LVNA CONTACTS

President	Imelda Misch	president@lvnasv.org
1st VP	Tony Bugna	vp1@lvnasv.org
2nd VP	Grace Keng	vp2@lvnasv.org
Treasurers	Linda Cain	treasurer@lvnasv.org
	Bev Woidyla	treasurer@lvnasv.org
Secretary	Lydia Fotiades	secretary@lvnasv.org
Newsletter	Ray Family	editor@lvnasv.org
Media	Ray Family	media@lvnasv.org
Advertising	Grace & Tony	ads@lvnasv.org

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts and Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety -- General Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety -- Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA MEETING RECAP

LVNA MEETING ON JAN 13

We congratulated the winners of the 2020 holiday lighting competition and had a general meet & greet with our Lakewood Village neighbors. Thanks again to everyone who joined us! It was great seeing some familiar faces (virtually) and meeting both new and long-time residents of the neighborhood. Note that, for privacy reasons, this meeting was not recorded.

LVNA ELECTIONS

LVNA board member elections are next month. Are you passionate about our neighborhood? Do you have big ideas and/or skills to bring to the table? You should consider running for one of the five board positions! Please contact any of the current board members with your notice of interest. Don't want an official position? We have plenty of committee and other volunteer options that would be perfect for you! Head over to LVNASV.org/contact and send us a message with your ideas and/or interest in helping out. This is a great opportunity to help actively drive change in our community and make a positive impact on our neighborhood. Please come show your support by either running or voting in the LVNA board member elections on March 10th. We're always looking for a helping hand so, even if you aren't quite ready, we'd love the help any time throughout the year – Suggest an activity/event, write an article for the Villager, virtually lead a neighborhood class (any painters out there?), … the options are endless.

UPCOMING EVENTS

FEBRUARY

10 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

MARCH

10 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.

LVNA CRV Recycling Drive

Have cans or bottles to recycle? Email us at recycle@lvnasv.org and one of our volunteers will coordinate a time to swing by to collect them. 100% of the funds will be used for future LVNA neighborhood events and expenses.